

Romeo and Juliet

Act III, Scene I (excerpt)

William Shakespeare

Enter MERCUTIO, BENVOLIO, Page, and Servants

BENVOLIO

I pray thee, good Mercutio, let's retire:
The day is hot, the Capulets abroad,
5 And, if we meet, we shall not 'scape a brawl;
For now, these hot days, is the mad blood stirring.

MERCUTIO

Thou art like one of those fellows that when he enters the confines of a tavern,
10 ~~claps me~~ ^{claps} his sword upon the table and says 'God send me no need of thee!'
and by the operation of the second cup draws it on the ~~drawer~~ ^{drawer}, when indeed
there is no need.

vb. banker

sb. bartender

BENVOLIO

Am I like such a fellow?

MERCUTIO

15 Come, come, thou art as hot a Jack in thy mood as any in Italy, and as soon
moved to be moody, and as soon moody to be moved.

[...]

BENVOLIO

By my head, here come the Capulets.

MERCUTIO

20 By my heel, I care not.

Enter TYBALT and others

TYBALT

25 Follow me close, for I will speak to them. Gentlemen, good e'en'; a word with
one of you.

MERCUTIO

And but one word with one of us? Couple it with something; make it a word
and a blow.

TYBALT

30 You shall find me apt enough to that, sir, an you will give me occasion.

MERCUTIO

Could you not take some occasion without giving?

TYBALT

Mercutio, thou consort'st with Romeo,—

*vb. er ven med /
spiller sammen med*

MERCUTIO

35 Consort! What, dost thou make us minstrels? An thou make minstrels of us,
look to hear nothing but discords. Here's my fiddlestick; here's that shall
make you dance. 'Zounds, consort!

sb. spillemænd

*udr. ved kristi sår,
bandeord*

BENVOLIO
40 We talk here in the public haunt of men.
Either withdraw unto some private place,
And reason coldly of your grievances,
Or else depart. Here all eyes gaze on us.

MERCUTIO
45 Men's eyes were made to look and let them gaze.
I will not budge for no man's pleasure, I.

Enter ROMEO

TYBALT
Well, peace be with you, sir. Here comes my man.

MERCUTIO
50 But I'll be hanged, sir, if he wear your livery:
Marry, go before to field, he'll be your follower.
Your worship in that sense may call him 'man.'

sb. den uniform, som
dine tjenere går med,
dvs. "gør hvad du
siger"

TYBALT
55 Romeo, the hate I bear thee can afford
No better term than this: thou art a villain.

udr. ved jomfru
Maria

ROMEO
Tybalt, the reason that I have to love thee
Doth much excuse the appertaining rage
60 To such a greeting. Villain am I none;
Therefore farewell; I see thou know'st me not.

TYBALT
Boy, this shall not excuse the injuries
That thou hast done me; therefore turn and draw.

ROMEO
65 I do protest, I never injured thee,
But love thee better than thou canst devise,
Till thou shalt know the reason of my love.
And so, good Capulet,—which name I tender
70 As dearly as my own,—be satisfied.

MERCUTIO
O calm, dishonourable, vile submission!
~~Alla stoccata~~ carries it away.

idiom italiensk fæg-
teudtryk

Draws

75 Tybalt, you rat-catcher, will you walk?

TYBALT
What wouldst thou have with me?

MERCUTIO
80 Good king of cats, nothing but one of your nine lives; that I mean to make bold
withal, and as you shall use me hereafter, drybeat the rest of the eight. Will
you pluck your sword out of his pilcher by the ears? Make haste, lest mine
be about your ears ere it be out.

sb. sværdsmeden
pnep. før

TYBALT
I am for you.

85 *Drawing*

ROMEO
Gentle Mercutio, put thy rapier up.

MERCUTIO
Come, sir, your passado.

idiom italiensk fæg-
teudtryk

90 *They fight*

ROMEO
Draw, Benvolio; beat down their weapons.
Gentlemen, for shame, forbear this outrage!
Tybalt, Mercutio, the prince expressly hath
Forbidden bandying in Verona streets:
Hold, Tybalt! good Mercutio!

95

*TYBALT under ROMEO's arm stabs MERCUTIO, and flies
with his followers*

MERCUTIO
I am hurt.
A plague o' both your houses! I am sped.
Is he gone and hath nothing?

100

adj. færdig

BENVOLIO
What, art thou hurt?

MERCUTIO
Ay, ay, a scratch, a scratch. Marry, 'tis enough.
Where is my page? Go, villain, fetch a surgeon.

105

Exit Page

ROMEO
Courage, man; the hurt cannot be much.

110

MERCUTIO
No, 'tis not so deep as a well, nor so wide as a church-door; but 'tis enough, 'twill
serve: ask for me to-morrow, and you shall find me a grave man. I am
peppered, I warrant, for this world. A plague o' both your houses! 'Zounds,
a dog, a rat, a mouse, a cat, to scratch a man to death! a braggart, a rogue,
a villain, that fights by the book of arithmetic! Why the devil came you
between us? I was hurt under your arm.

115

adj. færdig

ROMEO
I thought all for the best.

MERCUTIO
Help me into some house, Benvolio,
Or I shall faint. A plague o' both your houses!
They have made worms' meat of me. I have it,
And soundly too. Your houses!

120

125

Exeunt MERCUTIO and BENVOLIO

ROMEO

130

This gentleman, the prince's near ally,
My very friend, hath got his mortal hurt
In my behalf; my reputation stain'd
With Tybalt's slander,—Tybalt, that an hour
Hath been my kinsman! O sweet Juliet,
Thy beauty hath made me effeminate
And in my temper soften'd valour's steel!

Re-enter BENVOLIO

135

BENVOLIO

O Romeo, Romeo, brave Mercutio's dead!
That gallant spirit hath aspir'd the clouds,
Which too untimely here did scorn the earth.

ROMEO

140

This day's black fate on more days doth depend;
This but begins the woe, others must end.

Re-enter TYBALT

BENVOLIO

Here comes the furious Tybalt back again.

145

ROMEO

Alive, in triumph and Mercutio slain?
Away to heaven, respective lenity,
And fire-eyed fury be my conduct now!
Now, Tybalt, take the 'villain' back again,
That late thou gavest me; for Mercutio's soul
Is but a little way above our heads,
Staying for thine to keep him company:
Either thou, or I, or both, must go with him.

idiom nâde

150

TYBALT

155

Thou, wretched boy, that didst consort him here,
Shalt with him hence.

ROMEO

This shall determine that.

They fight; TYBALT falls and dies

160

BENVOLIO

Romeo, away, be gone!
The citizens are up, and Tybalt slain.
Stand not amazed: the prince will doom thee death,
If thou art taken. Hence, be gone, away!

165

ROMEO

O, I am fortune's fool!

BENVOLIO

Why dost thou stay?

Exit ROMEO

170

[...]